

Title: Trump's new order against AI regulation hits California especially hard

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California's AI regulation in the crosshairs of Trump executive order Nonprofit & Nonpartisan News CalMatters is your nonprofit and nonpartisan newsroom dedicated to explaining how state government impacts our lives. Posted in Trumps new order against AI regulation hits California especially hard !byDecember 11, 2025 December 11, 2025

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President Donald Trump issued an executive order cracking down on state AI regulations. The order would likely hit California hardest of all states. Trump speaks on election night in West Palm Beach, Fla. in November 2024 Photo by Chip Somodevilla, Getty Images **In summary** Since 2016, California enacted more AI regulations than any other state. The presidents new order against such laws worries state officials. *Keeping up with your California representatives felt impossible before. Now you can watch them like a hawk.; your weekly, personalized report that tracks what your state representatives say and do.* President Trump signed an executive order today to discourage state governments from regulating artificial intelligence and urge Congress to pass a law preempting such regulations. The order is likely to hit hardest in California, which since 2016 has passed more laws to regulate artificial intelligence than any other state, according to . California is also home to the worlds leading AI companies, including Anthropic, Google, Nvidia, and OpenAI. Trumps order would require the heads of the Federal Communications Commission, Federal Trade Commission, and Department of Justice to challenge state AI laws. It also calls for the development of model AI legislation to preempt or supersede state law unless those laws address childrens safety, data center infrastructure, state government use or AI, or other yet-to-be-determined areas. For states that continue to regulate AI, the order instructs federal agencies to explore whether they can restrict grants to them, including by revoking funding known as Broadband Equity, Access, and Deployment. California has a potential \$ at stake, much of which was and is set to deliver internet access to more than 300,000 people. In a earlier this week and today, Trump said the executive order was written to prevent businesses from needing to comply with laws from multiple states and that having to do so threatens Americas competitive advantage over other nations. Investors in tech startups, such as the Menlo Park venture capital firm Andreessen Horowitz, have urged the president to restrict state AI regulation and . Trumps order specifically criticized a Colorado law that requires testing and disclosure of AI that makes consequential decisions about peoples lives and seeks to prevent discrimination, a standard California lawmakers . Among recently-passed California laws that federal agencies may challenge are: * A ban on AI makers when defending themselves in court. * A prohibition on . * A requirement that the makers of AI to identify AI-generated photos, videos, and audio so that they can better spot fakes. * A law going into effect next month that about the data they use to train their models. 1. Just the right amount of news 2. Just the right amount of news 1. Get Californias most essential headlines without feeling overwhelmed. 2. Get Californias most essential headlines without feeling overwhelmed. Email address By clicking subscribe, you agree to the . Members of Congress routinely call California an example of AI regulation run amok, but lawmakers from both major parties have supported regulating AI, with more than 70 laws passed by 27 states this year, according to a . California again led the nation with the passage of roughly a dozen laws as Texas, Montana, Utah and Arkansas followed with the most AI bills signed into law this year. The executive order comes on the heels of a second attempt in Congress to preempt state AI laws, which . Republican members of Congress first attempted this spring, an initiative derailed in part by concerns about the fate of a law that protects country music musicians in Tennessee and others that seek to block child sexual abuse material. Polls show Californians and Americans support AI regulation. A released in October found that nearly 80% of Californians strongly or somewhat agree that, when it comes to AI, safety should be prioritized over innovation. A also found that four out of five Americans want lawmakers to prioritize safety over innovation, even if that means the technology is developed more slowly. More on AI PREEMPTION May 16, 2025 May 16, 2025 In addition to endangering the lives of children, artificial intelligence can lead to , and or that theyre entitled to. The technology is also power hungry, potentially driving up and endangering clean energy goals. It also needs large amounts of fresh water for the cooling systems in data centers. Center for Biological Diversity, an environmental group that sued to stop a California data center project one year ago, called the executive order an early Christmas gift to big tech. Opponents of the executive order say it leaves Californians vulnerable to harm. Make no mistake: this order doesnt create new protections, it removes them. Thats not governing. Thats a dereliction of duty wrapped in yet another distraction from a fracturing MAGA movement and a president who doesnt understand the real dangers of rapidly advancing tech, State Sen. Tom Umberg, a Democrat representing Santa Ana, said in a , when a draft of the executive order leaked to the press. In the California Legislature enthusiasm for regulating AI shows little sign of abating. More than 100 film industry workers from groups like the Animation Guild and SAG-AFTRA showed up at a committee hearing earlier this week about protecting the work of creatives. Many spoke in support of a what copyrighted material they use to train their models. Animation Guild president Danny Lin said at the hearing that in Californias film, television, and animation industries. L.A. is bleeding out before my very eyes, Lin told state lawmakers. In response to the executive order Lin told CalMatters calling out a Colorado law that seeks to prevent discrimination and protect working class people doesnt give her confidence that the legislation the president is calling for will address the concerns of creatives whose work is used to train generative AI models. Its pretty apparent that if we had a federal government that was actually focused on regulating this technology then the states would not feel the need to step in and create state specific legislation, she said. Read more from CalMatters Text Get breaking news on your phone.](Download Keep up with the latest via our app.)(Sign up Receive free updates in your inbox.)(Nonpartisan, independent California news for all Were CalMatters, your nonprofit and nonpartisan news guide. 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